

Mission Statement

CSCI 1510-001

Brandon Buchanan

I have always known that I wanted to work with computers. I am very skilled in many different disciplines, such as programming, hardware and software repair, and networking. Throughout high school, my career path changed. I wanted to become a game programmer, a computer repairman, and a network specialist. Until recently, I never decided on a specific discipline in which to shape my career. After contemplating and researching what I wanted to do, I decided I want to be a computer systems engineering; more specifically, a network security analyst.

My number one goal of my chosen career is to enjoy my job. I would enjoy waking up going to a job where I know my skills are being used in a productive manner rather than a job where I am only doing meaningless menial tasks. Another important goal for me is money. I am not all about the money, but would like to make enough to satisfy essential needs, and have money left over to just spend on something nice for myself, my friends, or family. Growing up, my family never had much money, and until recently when I got my job, I never had money to spend on something nice for myself. Making a good wage is important to me, and would be well earned.

The DISCOVER test helped me to verify that I wanted to be a computer systems engineer. It pointed out that I am interested, excel in, and I have values related to that of a career in engineering and technology. According to it, the salary range for a computer engineer is \$51,500 to \$94,500, which is a decent wage. It states that working separately is common with computer engineers, which is what I am most comfortable in doing.

The MBTI told me that I am an ISTP. To sum that up, I am a introverted thinker that learns with hands-on experience, and is flexible enough to make changes to plan on the fly. I can agree with that mostly. I think that I am more of an ISTP/J. I can make changes to plans, but I usually do so with dislike. I like to know how things are going to happen and I like to be early to

appointments because I would not want to be late if something were to come up suddenly. This is mostly because I like to think about situations before I act and possibly do something that I should not. This relates to my career very closely. Many computer science majors are introverted, and like to decide about how a certain situation will go. Although I had an idea of my personality type, the MBTI gave me words, examples, and a definition to how I would react to the world around.

The best advice that I received from the professor interviews was to pay attention to detail. Many applications today for personal computers are very user-friendly with graphical user interfaces, but when pursuing a career in information technology, there is not always a graphical user interface. Instead, what one would have to work with in many cases would be command line. This environment can be challenging and requires a lot of attention to detail so that every command is entered in correctly. If just one command is not entered correctly, then the entire task could be affected negatively. Another piece of important advice I received was to not go it alone. Professors are there to help those willing to learn the material. Even though I do not always want to ask for help in classes, I know that it is the best way for me to learn the material.

The pathway in deciding which career to choose has been long. While I had always known what general discipline I wished to pursue, it was hard for me to decide which area I would train myself in and become specialized. After contemplating long enough, I decided I wanted to become a network security analyst, and made plans to fulfill that decision. It may even be so that in ten years, I change my career and become an astronomer. I am still traveling down the path of life, enjoying the view, and discovering more about myself along the way.